What I Built This Week (Simple Explanation)

Date: May 30, 2026
Timeframe: Past 7 days
Reading Level: For anyone - no technical background needed

THE BIG PICTURE

I built a safety system for AI that checks everything before it happens, like having a careful friend who double-checks your work. I also created a way to measure how confident we are in our decisions, and a checklist to make sure everything is working properly before we show it to people.

WHAT I MADE (IN PLAIN ENGLISH)

1. Safety Check System (Like a Careful Friend)

What it is: A system that checks if computer actions are safe before they happen.

Why it's new: Most AI systems just do what you ask. This one checks first, like having a safety inspector who says "wait, is this safe?" before anything happens.

What it does:

- Checks if commands are dangerous before running them
- Blocks unsafe tools from being used
- Logs everything so we can see what happened
- Requires human approval for important actions

Real-world example: Like having a co-pilot who checks your work before you submit it.

2. Confidence Measuring System (Like a Weather Forecast)

What it is: A way to measure how confident we are in our predictions, and learn from mistakes.

Why it's new: Most systems either say "this will work" or "this won't work." This one says "I'm 70% confident" and then actually checks if it was right.

What it does:

- Predicts outcomes with confidence levels
- Records what actually happened
- Learns from mistakes
- Gets better over time

Real-world example: Like a weather forecaster who says "70% chance of rain" and then checks if it actually rained to get better at predicting.

3. Demo Safety Checklist (Like a Pre-Flight Check)

What it is: A checklist to make sure everything is safe before showing the system to people.

Why it's new: Most demos just happen. This one requires passing safety checks first, like a pilot doing a pre-flight check before takeoff.

What it does:

- Requires proof that the system works (evidence)
- Checks that safety systems are working
- Has a backup plan if something goes wrong
- Gets explicit permission from people involved

Real-world example: Like a restaurant health inspection before opening to the public.

4. 12-Step Quality Checklist (Like a Building Inspection)

What it is: A 12-step process to make sure everything is documented, tested, and working before saying "this is done."

Why it's new: Most projects just finish when they feel done. This one has a specific checklist with 12 steps that must all pass.

What it does:

- Checks that documentation exists
- Makes sure problems are fixed
- Tests that things actually work
- Has a way to undo changes if needed
- Requires approval before promotion

Real-world example: Like a building inspector who checks plumbing, electrical, structure, and safety before giving a certificate of occupancy.

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5. 30-Day Decision Framework (Like a Sprint Plan)

What it is: A 30-day cycle for making decisions and learning from them.

Why it's new: Most decision frameworks are either too slow (yearly planning) or too fast (daily changes). This one is 30 days - long enough to see results, short enough to adjust quickly.

What it does:

- Sets a 30-day goal
- Makes a prediction with confidence
- Takes action
- Measures what actually happened
- Learns and adjusts for next cycle

Real-world example: Like a fitness program where you set a 30-day goal, track your progress, and adjust based on results.

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6. Evidence-Based Promotion System (Like a Belt System in Martial Arts)

What it is: A system where things start as "theoretical" and only get promoted to "proven" after evidence.

Why it's new: Most systems either claim something works or don't. This one has levels: theoretical → prototype → proven → production, with evidence required at each step.

What it does:

- Starts with "this might work" (theoretical)
- Moves to "we built a prototype" (prototype)
- Requires evidence to say "this actually works" (proven)
- Only then can be used in real situations (production)

Real-world example: Like martial arts belts - you don't get a black belt until you've proven you can do the moves.

WHY THESE THINGS MATTER

For Regular People

- Safer computer use (things are checked before they happen)
- More honest predictions (we say how confident we are, not just "it will work")
- Better quality (things are tested before being called "done")

For Businesses

- Less risk (safety checks prevent mistakes)
- Better decision making (confidence measurements help predict outcomes)
- Higher quality (12-step checklist ensures things work)

For Creative Work

- Safer experimentation (safety checks allow trying new things)
- Better learning (30-day cycles help improve quickly)
- Clear progress (evidence-based promotion shows actual improvement)

WHAT MAKES THIS DIFFERENT

Traditional AI Systems

- Do what you ask without checking
- Say "this will work" without measuring confidence
- Call things "done" without testing
- No safety checks before public use

What I Built

- Checks safety before doing anything
- Measures confidence and learns from mistakes
- Requires evidence before saying something works
- Has safety gates before public use

THE SIMPLE VERSION

I built:

1. **Safety checks** - like having a careful friend double-check your work
2. **Confidence measuring** - like a weather forecaster who learns from predictions
3. **Demo safety checklist** - like a pre-flight check before takeoff
4. **12-step quality checklist** - like a building inspection before occupancy
5. **30-day decision cycles** - like a fitness program with 30-day goals
6. **Evidence-based promotion** - like martial arts belts that require proof

All of these work together to make AI safer, more honest, and higher quality.

WHAT'S NEXT

- Collect evidence to prove things actually work
- Test the safety systems with real situations
- Use the 30-day cycles to improve quickly
- Move things from "theoretical" to "proven" with evidence

Made by: Alex Place
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